Retrieval practice versus restudy for delayed recall of statistics concepts: a randomised laboratory experiment

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Abstract

In a laboratory experiment, 148 undergraduates were individually randomised to practise statistics concepts by retrieval or by restudy. Retrieval practice improved recall one week later (d = 0.52).

1. Methods

Design: individually randomised laboratory experiment with two arms. Participants: 148 undergraduates from a psychology participant pool. Procedure: participants studied six short texts on statistics concepts, then either answered recall questions (retrieval) or reread the texts (restudy). Outcome: free recall one week later, scored by two raters blind to condition.

2. Results

Delayed recall was higher after retrieval practice than after restudy (d = 0.52, 95% CI 0.19 to 0.85).

3. Limitations

The materials were laboratory texts rather than course content, retention was tested at one week only, and all participants came from one participant pool.

Fictional paper generated to test evidence-table extraction. Authors, journal, data and results are invented.